

ParkLyst

Go-to-market strategy and financial feasibility plan for an AI-powered urban parking platform

39M TL

total investment

7

strategic frameworks

%70

profit margin

3.9 yrs

payback period

Academic team project · Istanbul University · Portfolio edition curated by Emircan Görür

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Break-even reachable at 28% of daily capacity

ParkLyst is a mobile-first platform letting drivers find, reserve, and pay for parking in real time. Powered by IoT sensors, AI-based routing, and dynamic pricing, it targets Istanbul's chronic urban parking problem. At the planned daily capacity of 500 vehicles, the break-even threshold of 142 vehicles/day represents just 28% utilization — indicating a strong viability buffer before the business reaches profitability.

Break-even point	4,250 vehicles/month (142/day)
Capacity utilization at break-even	~28% of 500 vehicle/day capacity
Projected monthly revenue at capacity	1,200,000 TL
Annual net profit (projected)	10,320,000 TL
Profit margin	%70
Payback period	3.9 years

Business implication: the platform has significant headroom between break-even and capacity, reducing downside risk in the early growth phase.

BUSINESS CONCEPT

A full urban mobility solution, not just a parking space finder

WHAT Real-time parking discovery, AI-powered navigation, mobile reservation and payment in one flow.	FOR WHOM Urban drivers in Istanbul — white-collar commuters, shoppers, and corporate fleets. Municipalities as institutional partners.	HOW IoT sensors feed live occupancy data. AI matches users to optimal spaces based on location, traffic, and usage history. Dynamic pricing maximizes yield.
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STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK

Seven analytical frameworks shaped the plan

PEST Analysis	Mapped macro-environmental factors driving urban mobility needs
Porter's Five Forces	Assessed competitive intensity, entry barriers, and supplier/buyer power
SWOT Matrix	Identified internal advantages (IoT capability, exemptions) and market risks
STP Framework	Differentiated targeting across individual and corporate user segments
7P Marketing Mix	Full go-to-market program covering product, price, place, promotion, people, process and phy
Break-even Analysis	Determined minimum vehicle throughput for cost recovery
Gantt Timeline	Phased development roadmap from feasibility study to multi-city expansion

MARKETING STRATEGY

Differentiated targeting and comparative positioning

A differentiated marketing strategy was selected over mass marketing, because Istanbul's parking problem affects different user profiles in different ways. Two core segments received tailored value propositions:

Individual Drivers Time savings, fast parking discovery, mobile payment, loyalty rewards. Acquired via digital ads, referral system, and first-use free parking.	Corporate / Fleet Users Occupancy analytics, revenue optimization, employee transport management. Acquired via B2B field sales and institutional partnership proposals.
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Positioning: Comparative positioning vs. existing Turkish parking apps that only show available spaces. ParkLyst differentiates on AI personalization, dynamic pricing, eco-routing, and an end-to-end mobile experience.

Pricing: Market-rate entry (40 TL/hour, first 15 min free) to build user habit, transitioning to above-market pricing as brand value is established. Dynamic pricing layer optimizes yield against real-time demand.

INVESTMENT PLAN

39,000,000 TL total — majority in technology infrastructure

IoT sensor infrastructure	10,000,000 TL
Marketing and promotion	5,500,000 TL
Mobile and web app development	6,000,000 TL
Renewable energy systems	4,000,000 TL
Server and cloud infrastructure	3,000,000 TL
Parking area renovation and landscaping	1,500,000 TL
HQ and operations center	2,000,000 TL
Training and first-year staff costs	2,000,000 TL
Equipment and storage infrastructure	1,000,000 TL
Core total	35,000,000 TL

Contingency reserve	4,000,000 TL
Grand total	39,000,000 TL

Funding sources: founder equity contributions, TÜBİTAK grants, KOSGEB incentives, İTTO Teknopark support programs. Available tax exemptions include VAT, income tax withholding, employer SSI contribution, customs duty, and corporate tax relief through technopark status.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Five priorities to drive adoption and financial sustainability

- 01 Lead with accessibility**
Make fast, reliable parking access the core brand promise in all consumer communications.
- 02 Activate B2B early**
Corporate revenue from fleet and institutional clients stabilizes cash flow before consumer scale is reached.
- 03 Maximize public incentives**
TÜBİTAK, KOSGEB, and İTTO Teknopark programs materially reduce effective capital cost — apply early.
- 04 Build loyalty before scaling paid ads**
Referral system and tiered rewards generate lower-cost users with higher retention than broad awareness spend.
- 05 Demand proof from influencer activity**
Use niche automotive and urban-lifestyle creators; require measurable incremental outcomes before scaling creator budgets.

RESPONSIBLE INTERPRETATION

Useful analysis — within clear limits

Study limitations • Academic business plan — projected figures, not audited results • No live pilot data to validate demand assumptions • Financial model based on modeled estimates • Istanbul-specific context; expansion dynamics not modeled	Portfolio ethics • Academic team project — not sole authorship • Student identifiers removed from portfolio edition • No raw personal data included • Findings preserved without fabrication or embellishment
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Skills demonstrated Business Planning · Marketing Strategy · Break-even Analysis · Porter's Five Forces · SWOT Analysis · 7P Marketing Mix · Market Segmentation · Financial Modeling